

Daily AI, Crypto & Tech Power Briefing

July 3, 2026

AI Investors Ask for Proof as Stablecoins Move Toward Payments

Today is about the gap between big technology promises and real execution. AI is still the strongest market story, but investors are starting to ask harder questions about agents, chips, cloud capacity and profit.

Crypto has a different kind of test. Bitcoin is still sensitive to ETF flows and macro pressure, while stablecoins are becoming the part of blockchain that banks, payment companies and Big Tech can actually use.

1. AI stocks are not falling because AI is dead. They are falling because expectations are high.

Associated Press · July 3, 2026

World shares are mixed ahead of July 4 holiday

The story

AP reports that global markets were mixed after the Dow hit another record, while AI-related stocks continued to move unevenly. The Nasdaq fell 0.8% on Thursday as chip names such as Micron, Nvidia and Lam Research weighed on the index.

The important point is not that investors have stopped believing in AI. The issue is that AI stocks are now priced for very strong results. When prices already assume huge future profits, even a small worry about margins, demand or capex can move the market.

Why it matters

This is a useful signal for reading the AI cycle. The first phase was excitement: chips, data centers and every AI-linked company went up together. The second phase is more selective: investors want to know which companies can turn AI spending into real earnings.

The policy angle is also important. AP noted that a weaker U.S. jobs report may reduce pressure for more Fed rate hikes. Lower rates usually help risk assets, but they do not solve the bigger AI question: who actually captures the value from all this infrastructure spending?

What to watch

- Whether Nvidia, Micron and other chip names can stabilize before earnings season.
 - Whether Big Tech gives clearer numbers on AI revenue, productivity gains or cost savings.
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2. Meta's AI agent problem shows why useful products matter more than big promises

Barron's · July 3, 2026

Meta AI Fears Ease Despite Zuckerberg's Disappointment in Agents

The story

Barron's says Mark Zuckerberg has been disappointed that AI agents have not developed faster. That sounds negative, but it also shows where the industry is right now: everyone wants AI agents that can complete real tasks, but the product quality is still uneven.

Meta is not leaving the AI race. The company is still investing heavily, and investors are watching whether Meta can turn its large AI budget into products that improve ads, messaging, shopping, coding or customer service.

Why it matters

This matters because AI agents are supposed to be the next step after chatbots. A chatbot answers questions. An agent should actually do work. If agents remain unreliable, companies may struggle to charge premium prices or prove clear return on investment.

For Meta, the business question is direct: can AI protect and expand its advertising machine? If better AI tools increase ad performance or user engagement, Meta benefits. If the technology stays impressive but not useful enough, the market will treat AI spending as a cost.

What to watch

- Whether Meta shows agent features that normal users and advertisers actually use every day.
 - Whether OpenAI, Google and Anthropic can turn agent demos into reliable business tools faster than Meta.
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3. Nvidia is trying to make AI compute easier to finance

Barron's · July 2, 2026

Nvidia Stock Rises Amid New Revenue Sharing Plan for AI Startups

The story

Barron's reports that Nvidia is backing smaller AI cloud companies through a revenue-sharing and credit-support model. The idea is simple: smaller AI players often want Nvidia hardware, but they cannot always finance huge GPU clusters on normal terms.

Under this model, Nvidia helps support the buildout and then receives a share of cloud revenue from supported capacity. It is a way for Nvidia to expand demand beyond the largest hyperscalers, especially as Google and Amazon push their own custom AI chips.

Why it matters

This is a business-model shift. Nvidia is not only selling chips; it is trying to become part of the AI cloud income stream. That could create more recurring revenue, but it also ties Nvidia more closely to the financial health of its customers.

Investors will watch the risk of circular financing. If Nvidia helps customers buy Nvidia products, the market needs to know whether the end demand is real. The good version is ecosystem building. The bad version is demand that depends too heavily on vendor support.

What to watch

- Whether this model brings real utilization from paying AI customers, not just bigger hardware orders.
 - Whether regulators or investors ask for more disclosure around customer financing and revenue quality.
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4. Stablecoins are moving from crypto trading into mainstream payment competition

The Wall Street Journal · June 30, 2026

BlackRock, Google Join Banks and Crypto Firms in Backing New Stablecoin

The story

The Wall Street Journal reports that a group including BlackRock, Google and Coinbase is backing a new dollar stablecoin called Open USD. The token is expected to run on Base, Solana and other networks, with more than 140 companies signed up to use it.

This is important because the names involved are not only crypto-native firms. Payment companies and financial institutions are now treating stablecoins as payment infrastructure, not just as tools for traders moving money between exchanges.

Why it matters

Stablecoins are becoming the most practical blockchain use case for institutions. They can move dollars quickly, operate across borders and settle transactions outside normal banking hours. That is attractive for payments, remittances and tokenized financial products.

Regulators will care because stablecoins sit close to the banking system. They raise questions about reserves, consumer protection, anti-money-laundering rules and monetary sovereignty. The U.S. Genius Act gave the sector more legal structure, but competition may now intensify quickly.

What to watch

- Whether Open USD gets real payment volume or mainly becomes another crypto-market token.
 - Whether Circle's USDC and Tether's USDT lose pricing power as large partners back alternatives.
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Useful terms

priced for perfection - 估值已经反映很高预期	earnings power - 盈利能力
capex - 资本开支	risk assets - 风险资产
return on investment - 投资回报率	AI agent - AI 智能代理
product-market fit - 产品市场匹配	user engagement - 用户参与度
cloud capacity - 云算力容量	revenue-sharing model - 收入分成模式
credit support - 信贷支持	hyperscaler - 超大规模云服务商
custom AI chips - 定制 AI 芯片	circular financing - 循环融资
utilization - 使用率 / 产能利用率	revenue quality - 收入质量
stablecoin - 稳定币	payment infrastructure - 支付基础设施
tokenized assets - 代币化资产	reserve backing - 储备资产支持
anti-money-laundering rules - 反洗钱规则	monetary sovereignty - 货币主权

Today's big picture

Today's big picture is that AI is still the leading technology trend, but the market is becoming less patient. Investors now want proof that agents work, compute gets used and capex becomes earnings.

Crypto's strongest near-term story is not a new coin narrative. It is stablecoins becoming payment infrastructure for banks, tech companies and global commerce. AI is fighting to prove profitability, while stablecoins are fighting to become useful.